began a round of visits to Vale operations throughout the world. The raised expectations were dashed by Vale's pointed snubbing of union leaders throughout his inaugural tour of Vale's global operations. In response to criticisms he did, however, agree to meet with the 14 presidents of Vale operations linked to mining in Brazil on 23 September 2011.

According to a report by Valerio Vieira, President of Metabase Inconfidentes union, which represents two Vale mines in the Minas Gerais state, most of the union leaders present were happy to buy into Ferreira's notion of a kinder, gentler Vale and praised his readiness to dialogue with them. They lauded his visible emotion during the discussion on workplace fatalities. Vieira, who had worked for Vale on and off for 25 years, was not convinced. In his report to Metabase, shared with Vale activists in other countries, Vieira recounted saying to Ferreira that it would take a great deal more than three months for him to change the course of Vale after a decade under Agnelli's leadership. Moreover, it would take a level of political will not yet demonstrated.

> I said to him [Murilo Ferreira] and to those present that every time we have a meeting with the company management we are told that things are getting better, but there is a contradiction. What is said in Rio is contrary to what happens on the ground in Minas. Workplace accidents continue and they are being covered up. The harassment by managers has never been so intense. The unjust punishments and dismissals are of such proportions that it will be difficult to convince the union in Metabase Inconfidentes and our members that things are going to change. Mr President, you will have to convince us because up to now, nothing has changed (Vieira 2011).

Vieira's report on the meeting identified eight characteristics of working for Vale in Brazil: (1) Vale is noted for being very anti-union; (2) A Vale worker tends to earn less than workers in similar workplaces; (3) Vale managers engage in constant bullying of workers; (4) Vale imposes unrealistically high production goals, thus creating the atmosphere of permanent stress which Vale promised to eliminate; (5) Vale workers live with the constant threat of being fired without due cause; (6) Vale supervisors impose arbitrary disciplinary measures with great frequency; (7) To work at Vale means to work in dangerous conditions because Vale puts production above all else and often covers up health and safety incidents; (8) Vale regularly tries to buy union and government leaders by offering them vehicles, travel, credit cards, etc.

In 2012, a small sample of Vale workers in Canada, Mozambique and Brazil